

THE **gathering**

SIX WEEKS IN PHILIPPIANS

Joy Unshakeable

AGES 4 TO 7

*Simple words. Big truths.
Fun activities.*

The Gathering Kids

THE GATHERING CTX · CLEBURNE, TEXAS

For our partners, with gratitude

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Six weeks. One letter. One very happy prisoner.

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FOR THE PARTNERS OF THE GATHERING CTX • NOT FOR SALE

The Settled Heart

Philippians 4:1 to 23

Joy in Chains

PHILIPPIANS 1:1 TO 30

God is with me, so I can choose joy every day.

MEMORY VERSE

In that I rejoice. Yes, and I will rejoice.

PHILIPPIANS 1:18

This week your child meets a man named Paul who sang to God from a jail cell. The goal is not to make your child happy about hard things. The goal is to show them that joy comes from God being with them, not from everything going right. Read one day at a time with your child and let them say the words out loud at the end.

God Always Finishes What He Starts!

He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ.

PHILIPPIANS 1:6

Have you ever started building something with blocks and then someone knocked it over before you could finish? That is so hard! But here is something amazing about God. He finishes what He starts. Every single time.

A man named Paul wrote this verse from prison. He was in a jail cell, which is a hard, scary place to be. But even from jail, Paul knew something important. God started something good in him. And God was not going to stop working until it was completely done.

That is true for you too! God started something good in you when He made you His. And He is still working on you every single day. He will not stop until the job is completely finished!

Let's talk about it: Can you think of something you started and finished? How did it feel when it was done? How does it feel to know God will never stop working on you?

DO TOGETHER

Start drawing a picture together and do not finish it today. Come back tomorrow and finish it. Talk about how God is like that. He started you and He will always come back to finish the good work!

Parent note: This is the foundational truth of Philippians 1:6. God's sanctifying work is ongoing and guaranteed. Help your child understand that God's investment in them is permanent, not conditional on their behavior.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for starting something good in me. Thank You that You never stop and You never give up on me. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Paul Sang in Jail!

Always in every prayer of mine for you all making my prayer with joy.

PHILIPPIANS 1:4

A long time ago, Paul and his friend Silas were thrown into a really dark, cold jail. Their feet were locked in heavy chains. It hurt. It was scary. It was the middle of the night.

And do you know what they did? They sang! They sang songs to God right there in the dark. And then something amazing happened. An earthquake came! The doors flew open! The chains fell off!

The singing came first. The miracle came after. Paul was not happy because everything was going well. Paul was happy because God was with him no matter what. That is real joy. Joy that does not need everything to be perfect first!

Let's talk about it: When was a time things felt hard or scary? What helped you feel better? Do you think you could sing to God even when things are hard?

DO TOGETHER

Sing your favorite worship song together right now, even if nobody feels like it! See what happens to the room when you choose to sing to God!

Parent note: The Acts 16 account is concrete and engaging for children. The miracle followed the praise. This plants the seed that worship is not a response to good circumstances but a weapon in hard ones.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You that I can sing to You even when things feel hard. You are with me in the dark. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Even the Hard Stuff Can Help Other People!

What has happened to me has really served to advance the gospel.

PHILIPPIANS 1:12

While Paul was in jail, the guards had to be right next to him all day. They could not leave. And Paul used that time to tell them all about Jesus! The verse says his jail time helped the gospel go forward. Gospel means the good news about Jesus. The hard thing that happened to Paul, being put in jail, actually helped even more people hear the good news about Jesus!

Sometimes when something hard happens to us, God uses it to help someone else. Maybe you got sick and a friend came to visit and you got to tell them about Jesus. Maybe something scary happened and being brave helped another kid feel less scared.

God does not waste the hard things. He uses them!

Let's talk about it: Has anything hard ever happened that ended up helping someone else? Can you think of someone you could encourage this week?

DO TOGETHER

Write or draw a card for someone who is going through something hard right now. Tell them God loves them and does not waste hard things!

Parent note: Paul's chains reached the Praetorian Guard. Help your child see that their difficulties, big or small, can become a testimony that points others to Jesus.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You that You never waste anything. Use my story to help somebody else today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Be Brave Like a Good Team!

Standing firm in one spirit, with one mind striving side by side for the faith of the gospel.

PHILIPPIANS 1:27

Paul told his friends: stand together! Stay brave together! Do not give up! He used a picture of soldiers standing side by side with their shields up, protecting each other. That sounds like a really good team!

Being a Christian is like being on the best team ever. We help each other. We cheer each other on. We do not let each other fall down alone. When one person on the team is scared, the others stand next to them and say: we are right here. You are not alone!

Your family is part of that team. Your church is part of that team. We stand together!

Let's talk about it: Who is on your team? Who helps you stay brave? Is there someone on your team who needs you to stand next to them this week?

DO TOGETHER

Stand side by side with your family and link arms. Say together: "We stand together. We do not fall alone." Then pray for each person in your family by name.

Parent note: The military image of striving side by side is perfect for this age. Community and belonging are core developmental needs. Help your child identify their people and pray for them specifically.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for putting me on Your team. Help me stand next to somebody who needs me today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Choose Joy Every Single Day!

In that I rejoice. Yes, and I will rejoice.

PHILIPPIANS 1:18

Did you notice what Paul said? Paul was already rejoicing right then, in jail. And then he decided about tomorrow too. He said, I will rejoice. He did not say I will rejoice if things get better. He did not say I will rejoice when I get out of jail. He just said it plain. I will rejoice. He made up his mind ahead of time. He chose joy.

Joy is not just a feeling that happens to you when everything is good. Joy is something you can choose. Because Jesus is always with you. And nothing can change that.

Every morning when you wake up, you can choose: today I will rejoice! Not because everything is perfect. But because Jesus is with you. That is the best reason of all.

Let's talk about it: What is one thing you are happy about right now, even if today has been hard? How can you choose joy tomorrow morning the moment you wake up?

DO TOGETHER

Pray together and then choose one joyful thing to do as a family before bed, like a silly dance or a favorite song.

Parent note: You made it through all five days! This week, start each morning with your child by asking: are you going to choose joy today? It builds a habit of volitional praise that will carry them through life.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You that joy is something we can choose. Help us choose joy tomorrow morning, even before anything has happened yet. You are good all the time. In Jesus' name, Amen!

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I choose joy every day! Not because everything is perfect, but because Jesus is with me!

I walk with Jesus, and that means I win! Amen!

The Mind That Emptied Itself

PHILIPPIANS 2:1 TO 11

Jesus went low so He could lift me up, and I can be a helper too.

MEMORY VERSE

Jesus went low to help us, and God lifted Him up highest of all! (Philippians 2:9, made simple)

PHILIPPIANS 2:9

This week your child meets the biggest surprise in the whole Bible. Jesus was God and He had every right to stay in heaven, and He chose to come down and be a helper. Start each day by reminding your child that they are already loved and already God's before you ever ask them to do anything. Going low is not losing, and God is the one who lifts us up.

God Filled Your Heart Up First

So if there is any encouragement in Christ, any comfort from love.

PHILIPPIANS 2:1

Think about a cup filled all the way to the top with your favorite drink. When a cup is that full, it is easy to share some. You are not scared it will run out.

That is what God did for your heart. He filled you up with His love first. He hugged you first. He said you are Mine first. You did not have to earn one drop of it.

Because your heart is already full of God's love, you have plenty to share. You can be kind to your sister. You can be kind to the kid nobody is playing with. Full hearts share!

Let's talk about it: What is your favorite thing to drink when your cup is full? How does it feel to know God filled your heart with love first?

DO TOGETHER

Fill a cup with water almost to the top and pour a little into a second cup. Say together, "God filled me up first, so I have some to share!"

Parent note: Philippians 2:1 to 2. Paul grounds unity in what the believers have already received in Christ. Keep the order right for your child. Identity first, behavior second. They give because they have received, never to earn.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for filling my heart up with Your love first. Help me share it today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Jesus Left the Very Best Place

Though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped.

PHILIPPIANS 2:6

Imagine a king in a big warm castle. He has the best chair, the best food, and everybody says his name with a smile. He never has to leave. Nobody could make him.

Jesus was even better than that king. Jesus is God. Heaven is His home and it is perfect there. Nothing is sad in heaven. Jesus had every right to stay.

But Jesus came down anyway. He came down to us. Do you know why? Because He loves you that much. He did not have to come. He wanted to.

Let's talk about it: If you lived in a castle, would you want to leave it? Why do you think Jesus came all the way down to us?

DO TOGETHER

Build a tall tower with blocks or pillows. Then walk a toy or a person figure all the way down to the floor. Say, "Jesus came all the way down because He loves me!"

Parent note: Philippians 2:6. Jesus existed in the very nature of God and did not clutch His rights. Emphasize that the incarnation was chosen, not forced. Nobody took heaven from Jesus. He opened His hand.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You for leaving the very best place to come and get me. I am so glad You came. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Jesus Chose to Be a Helper

But emptied himself, by taking the form of a servant.

PHILIPPIANS 2:7

A servant is a helper. A helper does the jobs nobody else wants to do. A helper gets down on the floor. A helper cleans up the mess.

Jesus, the King of everything, became a helper. One night He got a bowl of water and a towel and washed His friends' dirty feet. Their feet were dusty and stinky from walking all day. The King washed them anyway.

Jesus did not stop being God when He became a helper. He was showing us what God is really like. God loves to help!

Let's talk about it: What is a job you can do to help at your house? How would you feel if a king washed your feet?

DO TOGETHER

Get a towel and take turns gently drying each other's hands. Say, "Jesus washed feet, so I can be a helper too!"

Parent note: Philippians 2:7. The word is *doulos*, the lowest rank in the Roman world. Jesus did not lose His identity in service. He revealed it. Let your child see helping as royal, not shameful.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You for being the best Helper. Show me one person I can help today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Going Low Is Not Losing

Therefore God has highly exalted him and bestowed on him the name that is above every name.

PHILIPPIANS 2:9

When you go down a slide, you have to climb up first. In God's family it works the other way around. Down comes first, and then God lifts you up.

Jesus went all the way down. Jesus obeyed His Father all the way down. All the way to the cross, where He died for us. He took all the wrong things we have done and He carried them away, so we could be forgiven. That is how far He went. He did it because He loves you. And three days later He was alive again, and He is alive right now.

And then look what God did! The Bible says God exalted Him, which means God lifted Jesus up higher than anyone else, ever. God gave Jesus the highest name there is, higher than any name anywhere. Going low was never losing. It was the way up!

Let's talk about it: Have you ever helped somebody when nobody noticed? Did you know God sees you? He is not keeping score. He just loves you.

DO TOGETHER

Crouch down as low as you can, then jump up as high as you can and shout, "God lifts me up!" Do it three times.

Parent note: Philippians 2:9. The exaltation flows out of the descent, not around it. Down before up. Servant before Lord. Assure your child that God sees hidden obedience. God lifts us because we are His, never as payment.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You that going low is never losing. Thank You for lifting Jesus up highest of all. In Jesus' name, Amen!

I Can Be a Helper Too

Let each of you look not only to his own interests, but also to the interests of others.

PHILIPPIANS 2:4

You belong to Jesus. You are loved. You are His. That was true before you did one single thing today.

And because you belong to Jesus, you get to think like Jesus. Jesus looks around a room and says, who needs Me? You can do that too. You can look for the kid sitting alone. You can share the last cookie. You can let somebody else go first.

That is the mind of Jesus, and it is yours. You do not have to be the biggest to be happy. God's helpers get to see what Jesus sees!

Let's talk about it: Who is one person you could look out for this week? What is one way you could let somebody else go first?

DO TOGETHER

Pick one person in your family and do one secret kind thing for them today without telling them it was you.

Parent note: Philippians 2:3 to 5. Humility here is not thinking less of yourself. It is a secure identity that is free to elevate someone else. Praise your child for the looking, not just the doing.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You that I am Yours. Give me Your eyes today so I can see who needs a helper. In Jesus' name, Amen!

SAY IT OUT LOUD

**Jesus went low so He could lift me up! I am loved,
and I can be a helper too!**

I walk with Jesus, and that means I win! Amen!

Work It Out, Walk It Out

PHILIPPIANS 2:12 TO 30

God is at work in me, so I can shine instead of grumble.

MEMORY VERSE

God is working inside you. He gives you the wanting and the doing! (Philippians 2:13, made simple)

PHILIPPIANS 2:13

This week your child learns that God is not far away watching. He is working on the inside, giving them both the wanting and the doing. That is why they do not have to grumble. They also meet two real helpers named Timothy and Epaphroditus. Keep the order clear all week. God works first, and then we get to walk it out.

God Is Working Inside You

For it is God who works in you, both to will and to work for his good pleasure.

PHILIPPIANS 2:13

Have you ever seen a seed in the dirt? Nothing looks like it is happening. But down inside, God is growing something real the whole time.

God is doing that inside you. He is not far away. He is not waiting to see if you are good enough. He is already working in you right now.

God even gives you the wanting. When you want to be kind, that is God working. When you go do the kind thing, that is God working too. You are not doing this alone. You never were!

Let's talk about it: What is something good you want to do? Did you know that wanting came from God?

DO TOGETHER

Plant a seed in a cup of dirt and put it in the window. Every day this week, say, "God is working in me even when I cannot see it."

Parent note: Philippians 2:12 to 13. Work out, never work for. God energizes both the desire and the deed. Guard your child from earning language. They cooperate with grace, they do not manufacture it.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for working inside me right now. Thank You for giving me the wanting and the doing. In Jesus' name, Amen!

No Grumbling!

Do all things without grumbling or disputing.

PHILIPPIANS 2:14

Grumbling is when you say things like, this is not fair, or I do not want to, or why do I have to. It sounds a little bit like a rumbley tummy, and it makes everybody's day feel heavier.

A long time ago, God's people got food from the sky and water from a rock. And they still grumbled! Grumbling made them forget how good God is.

You do not have to grumble, because God is working in you. When you say okay instead of no fair, something happy happens in the whole room. Try it and see!

Let's talk about it: What is one chore you usually grumble about? What could you say instead?

DO TOGETHER

Play the No Grumble Game at dinner. Every time somebody says a thankful thing instead of a grumbly thing, everybody claps once.

Parent note: Philippians 2:14. Paul uses the exact Greek word for Israel's murmuring in the wilderness. Complaining is a heart posture, not a personality. Model quick thankfulness out loud where your child can hear it.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, I am sorry when I grumble. Thank You that You are always good. Help my words be happy words today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Shine Like a Star

Among whom you shine as lights in the world.

PHILIPPIANS 2:15

Go outside at night and look up. Do you know when stars shine the very brightest? When it is the darkest.

A star does not wait for the dark to go away first. It just shines right in the middle of it. The dark can never turn a star off.

The Bible says you are a shining light. When you are thankful and kind while other people are grumpy, you are shining. God put the light inside you, so nothing out there can put it out!

Let's talk about it: When do stars shine the brightest? Where is one place you could shine this week?

DO TOGETHER

Turn off the lights and hold up one flashlight. Watch how one little light fills the whole room. Say, "I shine because God is in me!"

Parent note: Philippians 2:15. The word is *phosteres*, light bearers. It is the same word the Greek Old Testament uses for the sun and moon in Genesis 1. Your child does not generate the light, they carry it. Point out specific moments this week when you saw them shine.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for putting Your light in me. Help me shine today so people see how good You are. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Timothy Really Cared

I have no one like him, who will be genuinely concerned for your welfare.

PHILIPPIANS 2:20

Paul had a young friend named Timothy. Paul said something amazing about him. He said, there is nobody else like Timothy.

Why? Because Timothy really cared about people. Everybody else was busy thinking about themselves. Timothy noticed when somebody was sad. He asked how they were doing. And he meant it.

God noticed Timothy. God made sure his name was written in the Bible so that thousands of years later, we still know he was a young man who cared about people. Caring is never wasted!

Let's talk about it: How can you tell when somebody really cares about you? Who could you ask today, how are you doing?

DO TOGETHER

Ask one person today, "How are you feeling?" Then be quiet and really listen to their whole answer.

Parent note: Philippians 2:20 to 22. Paul calls Timothy *isopsuchos*, equal souled, a word Paul uses nowhere else in the New Testament. Character shows up in concern for others. Notice and name it when your child does it.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, help me be a kid who really cares. Show me somebody who needs me to notice them today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Epaphroditus Gave Everything to Help

For he nearly died for the work of Christ, risking his life to complete what was lacking in your service to me.

PHILIPPIANS 2:30

There was a man with a very long name. Epaphroditus. Can you say it? E paf ro Dye tus! His friends called him a brother, a helper, and a fellow soldier.

Paul was far away in jail, so Epaphroditus traveled a very long way over the sea to bring him a gift and take care of him. It was hard, and he got very sick doing it. He got so sick that he almost died. But God had mercy on him and made him all better.

And guess what he was worried about when he got well? Not himself. He was worried that his friends back home were worried about him! He gave everything to help. God has not forgotten his name, and God will never forget yours.

Let's talk about it: What is the longest name you can say? Who is somebody you would travel a long way to help?

DO TOGETHER

Make a card or a drawing for somebody who is sick or far away, and mail it or deliver it this week.

Parent note: Philippians 2:25 to 30. The word paraboleuomai means to gamble everything. Keep the ending happy for this age. God had mercy and he recovered. The point is love that closes the distance.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for helpers like Epaphroditus. Make me brave enough to help somebody even when it is hard. In Jesus' name, Amen!

SAY IT OUT LOUD

**God is working in me, so I can shine instead of
grumble!**

I walk with Jesus, and that means I win! Amen!

All Things Loss

PHILIPPIANS 3:1 TO 11

Jesus is the best thing I could ever have.

MEMORY VERSE

*Nothing is as wonderful as knowing Christ Jesus my Lord.
(Philippians 3:8, made simple)*

PHILIPPIANS 3:8

This week is about treasure. Your child will compare their favorite things to knowing Jesus and find out that Jesus wins every time. Along the way they will learn that being right with God is a gift, never a sticker chart. Read one day at a time and let your child say the words out loud at the end.

Happy in Jesus First

Rejoice in the Lord.

PHILIPPIANS 3:1

Before Paul told his friends about a problem, he told them to be happy in Jesus first. That is like putting on your seatbelt before the car starts moving. Being glad about Jesus keeps your heart safe and steady.

When you start your day happy that Jesus loves you, hard things do not get to be the boss of you. Jesus is the boss, and He is good!

Let's talk about it: What makes you happy when you think about Jesus? What is one thing that can feel hard, but Jesus is still bigger than it?

DO TOGETHER

Before breakfast, name one thing you love about Jesus together. Start the day happy in Him first!

Parent note: Philippians 3:1. Paul commands joy before he names a threat. Help your child see that joy in the Lord is an anchor, not a reaction to good circumstances.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, I am happy in You first. Thank You for being bigger than anything hard. In Jesus' name, Amen!

The Best Thing of All

Whatever gain I had, I counted as loss for the sake of Christ.

PHILIPPIANS 3:7

Paul had lots of things he was proud of. But he said something surprising. He said all of it was worth nothing compared to knowing Jesus.

Imagine your favorite toy in the whole world. Now imagine getting to hold Jesus' hand. Jesus is better than the best toy! Good things are nice. But Jesus is the best thing. Nothing else even comes close.

Let's talk about it: What is your most favorite thing you own? Did you know Jesus is even better than that?

DO TOGETHER

Hold your favorite toy in one hand. Then open both hands wide and say, "But Jesus is the best!"

Parent note: Philippians 3:7. Paul recategorizes his gains as loss next to Christ. Keep it concrete. Jesus is the treasure that makes everything else small by comparison.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, You are better than my favorite thing in the whole world. Thank You for being my very best treasure. In Jesus' name, Amen!

A Gift, Not a Sticker Chart

Not having a righteousness of my own... but that which comes through faith in Christ.

PHILIPPIANS 3:9

Sometimes we think God will love us more if we are extra good, like earning stickers on a chart. But Jesus does not work that way. He does not give us a sticker chart. He gives us a gift!

Being right with God is a present from Jesus. When we do wrong things, Jesus forgives us and makes us clean. You do not earn it. You just open your hands and say thank you.

Let's talk about it: Do you like getting presents? How does a present feel different from doing chores? Did you know God's love is a present, not a chore?

DO TOGETHER

Wrap a small treat in paper and let your child unwrap it. Say, "God's love is a gift, just like this!"

Parent note: Philippians 3:9. The gospel is grace received, not righteousness produced. Reinforce that God's acceptance is a gift through faith, never earned by behavior.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You that Your love is a gift. I open my hands and I say thank You. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Found Safe in Jesus

And be found in him.

PHILIPPIANS 3:9

Have you ever held a grown up's hand in a big, busy place? You feel safe because you are with them. The Bible says we are "found in" Jesus. That means we are safe and close to Him, like a big warm hug.

When you belong to Jesus, you are never lost. You are found. You are His!

Let's talk about it: When do you feel safest? Who do you stay close to? How does it feel to know Jesus holds you close?

DO TOGETHER

Give a big hug and say, "Jesus holds you even tighter than this!"

Parent note: Philippians 3:9. To be found in Him is our security and identity. Help your child feel safe in belonging to Jesus, not in being good enough.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You that I am safe with You. I am never lost, because I belong to You. In Jesus' name, Amen!

I Want to Know Jesus

That I may know him and the power of his resurrection.

PHILIPPIANS 3:10

There is a difference between knowing about someone and really knowing them. You might know about a famous person, but you really know your mom or dad because you spend time with them every day.

Paul wanted to really know Jesus, not just know facts about Him. Paul wanted to know the Jesus who died on the cross for him and came back to life. That is the same Jesus who knows your name. We get to know Jesus by talking to Him in prayer and listening to His Word. The more time we spend with Jesus, the better we know Him!

Let's talk about it: Who do you know really well? How did you get to know them? What is one way you can spend time with Jesus today?

DO TOGETHER

Pray a short prayer together. Let your child say one thing to Jesus all by themselves.

Parent note: Philippians 3:10. The goal of the whole passage is knowing Christ personally. Model simple, relational prayer so your child learns that knowing Jesus is a friendship, not a test.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, I want to really know You, not just know about You. I will talk to You every day. In Jesus' name, Amen!

SAY IT OUT LOUD

**Jesus is the best thing I could ever have! Nothing is
better than knowing Him!**

I walk with Jesus, and that means I win! Amen!

Press On: Citizens of Heaven

PHILIPPIANS 3:12 TO 21

I keep going for Jesus, because heaven is my real home.

MEMORY VERSE

Our home is in heaven, and Jesus our King is coming back!
(Philippians 3:20, made simple)

PHILIPPIANS 3:20

This week is a running week. Your child will learn to keep going, keep their eyes forward, and remember where they really belong. Mistakes do not disqualify them from the race. Keep the tone hopeful and excited, especially on the last day about Jesus coming back.

Keep Going!

I press on.

PHILIPPIANS 3:12

When you learn to ride a bike, you fall down. But you do not stop! You get back up and keep going. Paul said he keeps going for Jesus too. He does not quit.

We do not follow Jesus perfectly, but we keep going. Jesus is holding your hand the whole way!

Let's talk about it: What is something hard you kept trying until you could do it? Did you know Jesus helps you keep going?

DO TOGETHER

Have a little race across the room. When you finish, shout, "I press on for Jesus!"

Parent note: Philippians 3:12. Paul presses on because Christ has already made him His own. Help your child see we keep going from God's love, not to earn it.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You for holding my hand. Help me keep going and never quit. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Eyes Forward!

Forgetting what lies behind and straining forward.

PHILIPPIANS 3:13

When you run a race, you look at the finish line, not behind you. If you look back, you trip! Paul said he forgets what is behind and looks ahead to Jesus.

Maybe you made a mistake yesterday. That is okay. Jesus says keep your eyes forward! Yesterday is done. Today you run again.

Let's talk about it: What happens if you look backward while you are running? Is there a mistake you can give to Jesus and leave behind?

DO TOGETHER

Run a few steps looking back, then run looking forward. Which is easier? Eyes forward is best!

Parent note: Philippians 3:13. Forgetting means not letting the past set the pace. Reassure your child that mistakes do not disqualify them from running with Jesus.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You that yesterday is done. Help me keep my eyes forward on You today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Follow the Good Leaders

Keep your eyes on those who walk the right way. (Philippians 3:17, made simple)

PHILIPPIANS 3:17

When you play Follow the Leader, you watch the leader and do what they do. Paul said to watch people who love Jesus and follow how they live.

Pick good leaders to copy, like your mom, your dad, your teacher, people who follow Jesus. Watch the ones going the right way!

Let's talk about it: Who do you know that loves Jesus a lot? What is one good thing you could copy from them?

DO TOGETHER

Play Follow the Leader. Let the leader do kind things, like a high five or a hug, and everyone copies!

Parent note: Philippians 3:17. Formation happens by imitation. Point your child toward faithful, real life examples to watch and follow.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for people who show me how to follow You. Help me copy the good things they do. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Heaven Is My Home

Our citizenship is in heaven.

PHILIPPIANS 3:20

When you go on a trip, you are away from home for a little while. But your real home is still waiting for you! The Bible says heaven is our real home with Jesus.

We live here on earth right now. But we belong to heaven. You are a child of the King! Earth is the trip. Heaven is home.

Let's talk about it: What is your favorite part of being home? Did you know heaven with Jesus is your forever home?

DO TOGETHER

Draw a crown together. Color it gold and say, "I belong to Jesus, my King!"

Parent note: Philippians 3:20. Citizenship in heaven is identity, not escapism. Help your child feel they belong to Jesus even while living faithfully here.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You that I belong to You and heaven is my real home. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Jesus Is Coming Back!

Who will transform our lowly body to be like his glorious body.

PHILIPPIANS 3:21

Have you ever waited and waited for someone special to come, like a grandparent visiting? You get so excited! The Bible says Jesus our King is coming back, and we get to wait for Him.

And when He comes, He will make everything new, even us! Jesus is coming, so we watch for Him and we stay happy!

Let's talk about it: Who do you get excited to see come visit? How can we watch for Jesus and stay happy while we wait?

DO TOGETHER

Stand by the window and pretend to watch for someone special. Say, "Jesus, we are watching for You!"

Parent note: Philippians 3:21. The return of Christ brings a real, physical transformation. Frame it with hope and joy, not fear, for your child.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You that You are coming back. I am watching for You and I am so happy. In Jesus' name, Amen!

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Heaven is my real home! I belong to Jesus the King!

I walk with Jesus, and that means I win! Amen!

The Settled Heart

PHILIPPIANS 4:1 TO 23

God takes care of me, so my heart can be calm and happy.

MEMORY VERSE

God gives us a happy, calm heart that He guards for us!
(Philippians 4:7, made simple)

PHILIPPIANS 4:7

This is the last week of Philippians, and it is about a settled heart. Your child will learn to make peace with people, talk to God when they are afraid, choose good thoughts, and trust God as a good Father. This is a wonderful week for bedtime, when worries usually show up. Let your child say the words out loud every night.

Say Sorry and Be Friends

I entreat Euodia and I entreat Syntyche to agree in the Lord.

PHILIPPIANS 4:2

Have you ever had a little fight with a friend or your brother or sister? It does not feel good. In the Bible, two friends had a fight. Paul begged them, please be friends again!

God loves it when His family gets along. He is not waiting to be happy with you. He already is. You are God's kid, and God's kids say sorry fast and give hugs, because that is who you already are.

Let's talk about it: Have you ever had a fight with a friend? How did you make it better? What kind thing can you say to make a friend happy again?

DO TOGETHER

Give everyone in your family a big hug. Say, "I am so glad we are a family!"

Parent note: Philippians 4:2 to 3. Paul urges two co workers to be reconciled. Help your child see that God wants His family united, and kindness is how we mend a fight.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, thank You for my family and my friends. Help me say sorry fast and be kind. In Jesus' name, Amen!

God's Soldiers Guard Your Heart

The peace of God... will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

PHILIPPIANS 4:7

Do you ever feel scared or worried, maybe at bedtime when it is dark? When you feel that way, you can talk to God. Just tell Him all about it!

When you talk to God, He gives you peace. His peace stands guard like brave soldiers at a gate. God keeps your heart safe! You do not have to be afraid.

Let's talk about it: What is something that makes you feel worried sometimes? Did you know you can tell God anything, anytime?

DO TOGETHER

Stand up tall like a brave soldier guarding a gate. Say, "God's peace guards my heart!"

Parent note: Philippians 4:6 to 7. The word for guard is a military term for a garrison. When we pray, God stations His peace to stand watch over our hearts and minds.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, here is what I am worried about tonight. Thank You for guarding my heart. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Think About Good Things

Whatever is true... whatever is lovely... think about these things.

PHILIPPIANS 4:8

Your brain is like a toy box. You get to pick what goes inside! You can fill it with yucky, scary thoughts, or you can fill it with good, happy thoughts.

The Bible says to think about good and true things, like how much God loves you! Fill your mind with happy things about God! Good thoughts make a happy heart.

Let's talk about it: What is a happy thing you can think about right now? What is one true thing you know about God?

DO TOGETHER

Take turns naming happy, good things, like puppies, hugs, and God's love. Count how many you can name!

Parent note: Philippians 4:8. Paul tells us to deliberately fill our minds with what is true and good. Guide your child to choose God honoring thoughts on purpose.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, help me fill my mind with good and true things about You today. In Jesus' name, Amen!

Happy With Jesus, No Matter What

I can do all things through him who strengthens me.

PHILIPPIANS 4:13

Sometimes we have a lot, like a big plate of yummy food. Sometimes we have just a little. Paul said he learned to be happy either way, because he had Jesus.

Jesus makes us okay whether we have a lot or a little. Jesus is what makes our heart happy! Toys are fun, but Jesus is the best of all.

Let's talk about it: What is something you are thankful for today? Can Jesus make our heart happy even when we do not get what we want?

DO TOGETHER

Say three things you are thankful for. Then give Jesus a big cheer for being the best gift of all!

Parent note: Philippians 4:11 to 13. Paul learned contentment in plenty and in need. Help your child find joy in Jesus, not in how much they have.

PRAY TOGETHER

Jesus, thank You that You make my heart happy no matter what. You give me strength. In Jesus' name, Amen!

God Gives Us What We Need

My God will supply every need of yours according to his riches in glory in Christ Jesus.

PHILIPPIANS 4:19

A good mom or dad makes sure you have food to eat and a cozy bed to sleep in. They take care of you because they love you so much! And when a mom or dad cannot, God still never stops taking care of you.

God is our best Father, and He takes care of us too. God gives us everything we need! He never runs out of good things to give His kids.

Let's talk about it: What are some things God gives you every day? How does it feel to know God takes care of you like a good Father?

DO TOGETHER

Point to things God gives you, like food, your bed, and your family. Say, "Thank You, God, for taking care of me!"

Parent note: Philippians 4:19. God supplies our needs from His endless riches. Help your child rest in God as a loving, providing Father.

PRAY TOGETHER

God, You are my good Father. Thank You for giving me everything I need. In Jesus' name, Amen!

SAY IT OUT LOUD

**God is my good Father! He gives me everything I
need!**

I walk with Jesus, and that means I win! Amen!
